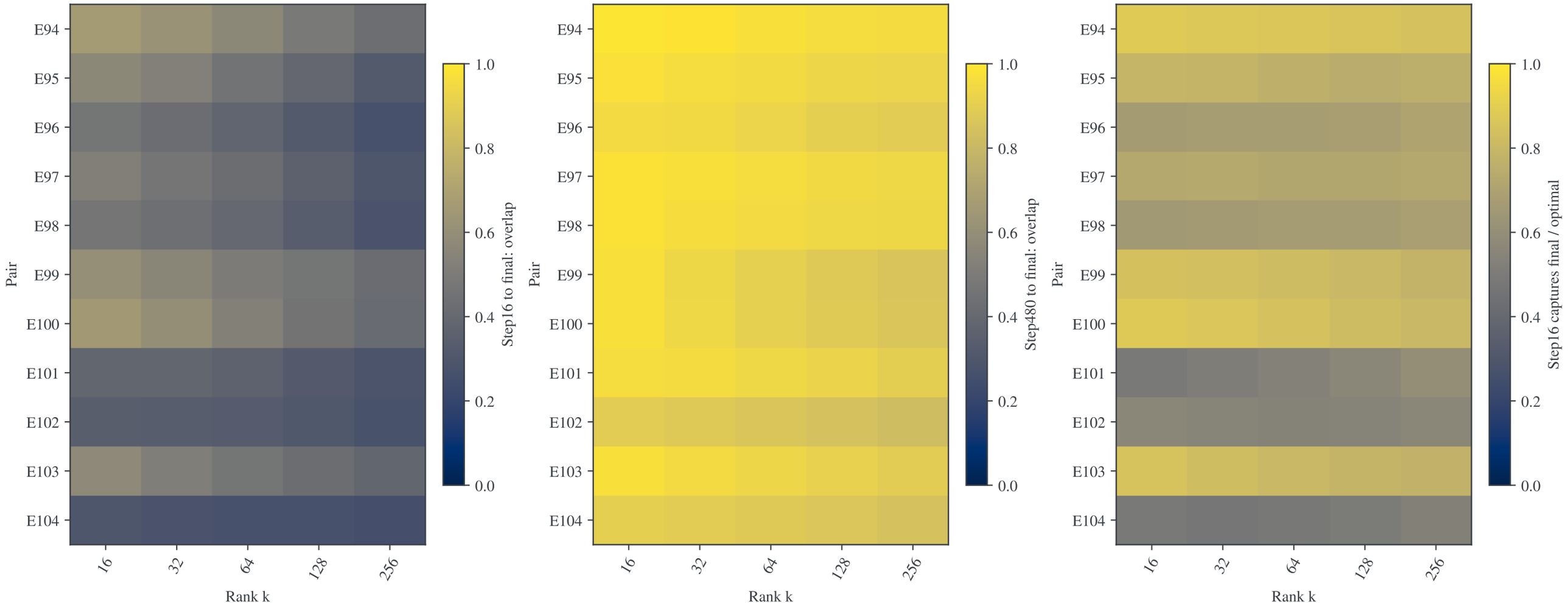
Early alignment separates pairs better than late stabilization



196 matrices/pair; medians; cumulative-update right subspaces; common 0–1 color scale.